Convening stakeholders across industries to craft principles and concrete codes of practice for the development and use of artificial intelligence.

March 14, 2025

RE: NITRD NCO, NSF, Request for Information (RFI) on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

These comments are submitted on behalf of the Alliance for Trust in AI (ATAI), a nonprofit association of companies using artificial intelligence (AI) representing diverse sectors. Members of ATAI seek to ensure that AI can be a trusted tool by promoting effective policy and clear codes of practice for AI. We appreciate the opportunity to respond to the National Science Foundation (NSF) and Networking and Information Technology Research and Development (NITRD) National Coordination Office's (NCO) Request for Information (RFI) on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan ("AI Action Plan").[1]

ATAI is appreciative of this Administration's focus on ensuring that the U.S. AI ecosystem is competitive, vibrant, and trusted. We also urge the Administration to pursue policies that will ensure that the U.S. AI ecosystem remains a leader in thoughtful guidance and multi-stakeholder best practices for the development, integration, and deployment of AI. It is key to establish common language and practices to design, develop, use, and evaluate AI while promoting technological advancement and leadership in the digital space.

We hope that the NSF and NCO will keep in mind the broad diversity of technologies, contexts, and uses of AI in developing these policies and actions. In particular, ATAI encourages guidelines, standards, and best practices that are broadly applicable across industries, and designed to be flexible over time and contexts in the evolving world of AI. We look forward to the forthcoming AI Action Plan and are committed to assisting in turbocharging the use of AI across American industries to benefit the public and private sectors alike.

About ATAI

The Alliance for Trust in AI brings together companies using advanced AI in many sectors to advocate for ways that we can build trust in all the kinds of AI that empower companies across the country and world. ATAI works with companies developing foundational AI models, creating

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1 https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2025/02/06/2025-02305/request-for-information-on-the-development-of-an-artificial-intelligence-ai-action-plan

AI systems, and implementing these systems and models in their own work across industries. We aim to give organizations concrete guidance around how to build AI responsibly, implement AI principles, support learning and information sharing across sectors, and establish a shared voice for the many users of AI. ATAI is building on work done by technologists, policymakers, and academics to create a shared understanding of how to develop and use AI in trusted ways. Through multi-stakeholder partnership with members across industries and sectors, ATAI is developing definitions, principles, and codes of practice that allow developers, implementers, and users of AI systems to demonstrate responsibility and accountability to advance this technology.

American Leadership in AI Innovation

The United States has been a pioneer in advanced and emerging technology, and has played a leadership role in AI development due to three key factors, each fostering innovation and ensuring its continued success in the field. Together, they can help ensure that the United States remains at the forefront of AI development and continues to influence its global direction:

- ***Trust***: Advancing measurement science, standards, and technology to deliver high-quality, secure, and trusted software products. By establishing robust frameworks for validation, the United States will foster confidence in its AI products, minimizing risks and ensuring widespread adoption both domestically and internationally.
- ***Partnership***: Strong collaboration between government and industry allows for innovation through R&D investments and the development of voluntary standards that promote trustworthy products. These partnerships create an environment that encourages both innovation and consensus-driven practices.
- ***Global Leadership***: Setting global AI standards by leveraging technological capabilities, promoting private sector innovation, and prioritizing national defense interests. This leadership allows the United States to shape international AI policies and ensure its influence on the global stage.

Trustworthy and Safe Adoption of AI Across Industry

Trust is fundamental to the widespread adoption of AI, and U.S. standards have played a critical role in establishing processes and measures to build that trust. The development of voluntary, multi-stakeholder standards and measurements, such as the National Institute of Science and Technology's (NIST) Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), has accelerated the deployment of AI by consolidating industry best practices that have organically emerged over time.[2] Similar efforts are underway within the NIST AI Risk Management Framework (RMF), which helps companies evaluate their choices in deploying AI systems and thoughtfully develop products that are accurate, robust, and reliable.[3] By continuing to lead in global standard-setting, the United States can further enhance customer trust and maintain its international leadership in the software space.

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[2] https://www.nist.gov/cyberframework
[3] https://www.nist.gov/itl/ai-risk-management-framework

As technology evolves, it is essential that standards and guidance not only address current and near-future risks but also remain flexible enough to adapt to the changing landscape of AI products, use cases, and markets. Scalability and adaptability are critical to ensure that AI systems can meet growing demands and adjust to fluctuating circumstances. Standards grounded in technical and scientific foundations provide stakeholders with the necessary tools to manage AI risks effectively while encouraging innovation by offering reassurance to developers and investors.

Given the potential risks involved in deploying AI, organizations across industries have developed governance frameworks aimed at addressing issues such as data integrity, safety, and resilience. In particular, ATAI's members have brought together a set of high-level principles around development, implementation, and use of AI based on this need for harmonized risk management. This collaboration ensures that standards are not only theoretically sound but also practically feasible and beneficial. The consolidation of these insights into comprehensive principles has helped shape AI governance, fostering safer and more reliable systems. Risk management frameworks, which draw on established, consensus-driven practices, are essential in driving the adoption of trusted AI systems, helping organizations mitigate reputational, liability, and data risks. These frameworks can be adapted to secure AI systems and guide organizations in managing emerging AI-related challenges.

Standards bodies like NIST offer consensus-based governance and technical guidance that should be leveraged by policymakers, ensuring that legislative language aligns with common definitions of AI technologies. This alignment will help reduce confusion and enhance compliance.

Public-Private Partnerships

Public-private partnerships that bring together the U.S. federal government, businesses, civil society, academia, and international partners are critical to advancing access to AI innovation infrastructure and will continue to play a significant role in its future development. The National AI Research Resource (NAIRR) Pilot serves as a prime example of how such partnerships can effectively drive progress by fostering collaboration among a range of stakeholders, fostering unified advancements in AI research and infrastructure.[4]

Similarly, NIST's ongoing standards work demonstrates the power of these partnerships in developing frameworks that guide AI's ethical and technical evolution, offering safe, reliable, and aligned with industry best practices. This collaborative model is further supported by a long history of federal investment in research and development, which has helped advance breakthroughs and set the stage for continuous innovation.

By enabling various companies to share resources, expertise, and knowledge, these partnerships promote industry-wide collaboration, ensuring that AI development benefits from a

[4] https://nairrpilot.org/

broad perspective that incorporates various areas of expertise. To maximize their impact, these efforts should harmonize with regional, national, and international laws and initiatives, ensuring that AI innovation is aligned with global standards and regulatory frameworks.

Global Engagement

The United States has long been a global leader in introducing both innovative technologies and methods to ensure their trustworthiness, with ongoing international standards work and collaboration being central to this effort. Achieving global consistency in AI standards is critical for reducing regulatory complexity and enhancing widespread trust in AI systems. It is essential that NIST and the U.S. government continue to lead and participate in international discussions to align standards globally. NIST is already a global standards-leader, and organizations around the world look to their standards as neutral, scientific approaches.

U.S. investments in foundational model development have resulted in AI models of superior quality, setting them apart from others that attempt to cut corners. This focus on developing core intellectual property not only yields better products today but also positions the United States to remain a leader as technology advances and computing power evolves. Encouraging other countries to adopt similar approaches will ensure the AI ecosystem fosters the development of core intellectual property and fair competition, sustaining American innovation on the global stage.

To maximize the global impact of AI, international and national rules must be harmonized to create a unified framework for AI development that benefits all. Fragmenting best practices and guidelines, even from non-U.S. sources, would hinder innovation. Horizontal standards, applicable across sectors as well as promoting interoperability, are necessary for minimizing sector-specific adaptations.

For successful international adoption, standards must be clear, implementable, innovation-friendly, neutral, and accessible to global users. Standards should also align with existing technology standards to avoid conflicts and enhance interoperability. Supporting frameworks like the NIST AI RMF, and promoting these standards globally in collaboration with international partners, will ensure consensus and drive forward a unified approach to powerful, trusted AI systems.

Conclusion

The Alliance for Trust in AI looks forward to continued collaboration with NCO and NSF to develop and refine voluntary standards and guidance that strengthen America's digital landscape, focused on supporting innovation while ensuring the security, reliability, and responsible use of AI. We find it incredibly important to balance innovation with responsible development and deployment, and we appreciate the ability to constructively weigh in on this important issue.

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on this request for information. If you have questions or believe that we can be helpful to your work in any way, please contact ATAI's coordinator Heather West, at [redacted]